'SAFE & SECURE'

INDUSTRY LEADERS SHARE INSIGHTS ON CONNECTED CAR TECHNOLOGY & THE CONTRIBUTION OF ADVANCED DRIVER ASSISTANCE SYSTEMS IN IMPROVING SAFETY



TARUN GARG
COO, Hyundai Motor India

Hyundai has cemented its position as a pioneer in futuristic technology and smart mobility with our connected car platform, Bluelink. The share of connected cars in our total sales has significantly increased from 5 per cent in 2019 to 31 per cent in 2024 (as of April 2024). Some of the most frequently used features are navigation/map view, vehicle status—where a customer can check whether a door/window is locked or not, vehicle health, live car tracking, trip history, remote function to start the engine and turn on/off the AC. Hyundai has been the first mover of introducing advanced safety systems such as ADAS across mass market products. In September 2023, we took a pioneering step by introducing first-in-segment ADAS for the Venue and Venue N Line, making them India's most affordable SUVs to be equipped with the technology. Currently seven Hyundai models come with ADAS. These models contribute to over 16 per cent (as of April 2024) of our total sales and 30 per cent in models with ADAS.

SANTOSH IYER
MD & CEO, Mercedes-Benz India



The 'Mercedes me' application is the stepping stone to the connected world of Mercedes-Benz and is extremely popular amongst our customers, with more than 80,000 connected cars. Customers love connected features like geo-fencing, advanced navigation, vehicle stats-check, location, car to X communications and a host of other features like pre-climatised cabin, remote start-stop, remote lock-unlock and also setting up service appointments. Through regular over-the-air (OTA) updates, our vehicles easily cater to customers' ever-changing preferences and desires. Mercedes-Benz pioneered ADAS [advanced driver assistance systems] features in India and we are glad to see them widely adopted now, enhancing customer safety and convenience. In addition to ADAS features, for the first time in India, Mercedes-Benz offered Level 2 Autonomous Driving with 'evasive steering assist' and active brake assist with 'cross traffic function'.



PARTHO BANERJEE
Senior Executive Officer, Marketing & Sales, Maruti Suzuki India

The Suzuki connect app has impressive activity metrics, with over 3,69,000 users, of which 94 per cent are 'monthly active users' while 20 per cent of the users engage with the app on a daily basis. A majority of the users have shown a preference for features such as live car parameters, including vehicle status on the app dashboard, location of the vehicle, and trip details. Notably, the remote AC scheduling feature in our vehicles has also received appreciation. Over-the-air (OTA) updates have allowed us to reach customers more efficiently and quickly. Case in point: when Smartplay Pro/Pro+ was initially launched with the Baleno, it lacked wireless Apple CarPlay and Android Auto accessibility. However, these features were later made available to existing customers through an OTA update.